

Lab 45 Worksheet — Windows OS Symptom

Diagnosis and Recovery Tools

Name: ____ Date: ____

Exam objective: Diagnose common Windows symptoms and select the correct recovery tool, escalating from least to most destructive (Core 2 objectives 3.1 and 3.2).

Record as you go

Step	What you did	What you observed
1	Build the escalation ladder from least to most destructive: reboot, restart the service, roll back the driver or update, System Restore, sfc and DISM, Startup Repair, Reset keeping files, Reset removing everything, then reimage.	
2	Record the guiding rule: always start at the lowest rung that could plausibly resolve the symptom, because every rung up costs the user more time and more data risk.	
3	Record what System Restore does and does not do: it rolls back system files, drivers and the registry, but it does not restore or remove personal files.	
4	Verify System Restore is enabled and list the available restore points, since a machine with protection disabled has no restore points at all.	
5	Diagnose a blue screen of death: record the stop code, identify what changed immediately before it, then roll back the most recent driver or update and test memory.	
6	Diagnose sluggish performance using Task Manager and Resource Monitor to identify which of CPU, memory, disk or network is saturated before treating anything.	

Step	What you did	What you observed
7	Diagnose frequent shutdowns by separating the causes: overheating, a failing power supply, corrupt system files or a failing driver, and give the test that distinguishes them.	
8	Diagnose applications crashing by checking Event Viewer's Application log for the faulting module, then repairing or reinstalling the application.	
9	Diagnose 'no OS found' by checking boot order, removing bootable USB devices, confirming the disk is detected, then repairing the boot record from the recovery environment.	
10	Diagnose a slow profile load by examining startup applications, and record that a roaming profile that has grown large is a common cause in a domain environment.	
11	Diagnose USB controller resource warnings, and record that too many devices on one bus is resolved by redistributing devices across controllers.	
12	Record how to access the Windows Recovery Environment — three failed boots trigger it automatically, or hold Shift while selecting Restart — and list the tools it provides.	

Verification

Success criterion: Your ladder orders all ten recovery options from least to most destructive; the symptom map assigns each of ten symptoms to a specific rung with justification; and you correctly state that System Restore does not affect personal files.

- I completed every step in the lab.
- My result meets the success criterion above.
- I recorded my evidence (screenshots, output, completed tables).

Reflection

What surprised you in this lab?

Where would you apply this on the job?

What do you still need to revise before the exam?
